IN ITS THIRD TERM, THE MODI GOVT HAS ALLOCATED AN ADDITIONAL Rs 50,000 CRORE TO BUILD EIGHT NEW HIGH-SPEED NATIONAL HIGHWAY CORRIDORS

self as a global economic superpower. This includes building the world's largest high-speed rail network, spanning over 40,000 km, the Three Gorges hydroelectric dam—the largest on the planet—and the advanced Beijing Daxing International Airport. China's urbanisation efforts and extensive 5G network development have also been pivotal, boosting economic growth and enhancing global connectivity.

INDIA'S GLOBAL POSITION

Where does India stand? According to the World Bank, the country spent around 29 per cent of its GDP on gross fixed capital formation in 2022, while China spent nearly 42 per cent. In contrast, developed countries like the UK, France, Germany, Japan and the US kept this figure within the range of 18-26 per cent of their GDP. In other words, it will take a while before India can scale down its infrastructure spending. This reflects the government's unwavering faith in the critical role of infrastructure in shaping India's growth story, given its multiplier effect on the economy, says Anup Sahay, head of corporate strategy and special initiatives at Larsen & Toubro. "A comprehensive and committed approach to infrastructure will enhance connectivity, create jobs, ensure holistic development, and improve living standards," he adds. The likes of Gadkari may be right—India's journey to joining the ranks of developed nations by 2047 may well be paved by the roads, trains and bridges being built today. ■

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